

Reference Grammar “ Dictionary

Contents

Dictionary	1
1. Schema	1
2. Collation Order	1
3. Orthographic Notes	2
4. Entries	2
5. Changelog	4

Dictionary

A working lexicon for the conlang. Entries are sorted in conlang collation order (see §2). Each entry uses a template-style schema: fields may be omitted when not yet committed. Fields marked [Open] depend on phonological or grammatical questions still under analysis in phonology.md or language_reference.md.

This file is a living specification. As sound rules settle and grammar commits, entries should be revisited and updated.

1. Schema

Each entry is a level-3 heading (### headword). Below the heading:

- ##### Etymology — A section opener. The proto-form in italics with asterisk, a dash, then a gloss. Semantic drift, register notes, and source-construction context are folded in as prose. Example: *pass out* — colloquial “fall asleep” primary; “lose consciousness” secondary (salience inverted from GA).
- **Form line:** Labeled fields on one line: **Part of speech:** abbreviation **IPA:** /.../ **Foot:** (...). Example: **Part of speech:** v. **IPA:** /beˈs:o/ **Foot:** (H)(H).

Then, if committed, a **Phonological development** line: a compact semicolon-separated list of applied rules with brief labels. This is a derivation record, not a discussion.

Then **Cross-refs** if any: a single parenthetical or line linking related entries.

Then prose sections as needed:

- ##### Definition — numbered glosses.
- Examples appear inline within the definition they illustrate, separated from the definition text by an em dash. Conlang form in italics, followed by the English translation in double quotes. No separate ##### Examples heading.

- ##### Morphology — inflected/derived forms when committed.
- ##### Notes — observations genuinely specific to this form: irregular surface properties, optional realizations, notable phonotactic patterns. Not for propagation tickets, pending rule discussions, or paradigm-candidate flags — those go in the session changelog or target document.

Any section may be omitted. When a committed field depends on an unresolved question elsewhere, mark [Open: see phonology §X].

2. Collation Order

The conlang alphabet, in sort order:

a, ȁ, b, ȃ, e, ȅ, æ, h, i, ii, k, l, m, ȡ, n, ȣ, o, ȇ, œ, p, r, rh, ȡ,
s, ȣ, ȥ, t, ȧ, w, ȩ, y, ȫ

Rules:

1. Within a base letter’s region, undiacriticked sequences sort first by Latin order on subsequent characters, then diacriticked forms follow.
 - Example a-region: a < aa < au < aȩ < ȁ
 - Example e-region: e < ee < eu < eȩ < ȅ
 - Example i-region: i < ia < iu < iȩ < iȡ < ȡ
 - Example o-region: o < oo < ou < oȩ < ȇ
2. ii and rh are distinct phonemes, not digraph extensions of i and r, and have their own slots in the alphabet:
 - i-region (all i-initial sequences and ȡ) < ii-region (ii, iia, etc.)
 - r < rh < ȡ — the devoiced tap ȡ sorts last because devoiced r and devoiced rh collapse to a single phoneme, placed at the end of the rhotic series.
3. æ and œ are independent letters slotted into the bare-letter sequence (after the a-region and after the o-region respectively), not treated as diacritic forms.
4. Consonant diacritic forms (ȡ, ȣ, ȥ, ȧ, ȩ, ȫ) follow their bare letter immediately, since consonants do not form length digraphs.
5. ȃ takes the slot where d would be (after b); ȧ takes its own slot (after t).

3. Orthographic Notes

A few conventions clarified during early entry-writing, supplementing orthography.md:

- The diphthong /ei/ (phonemically /ey/, with y /j/ as the glide) is written ei. This is distinct from the length digraph eu /ɛ:/ — e followed by i is the diphthong, e followed by u is length.
- **Geminate ss** represents /s:/ (voiceless long). This works in concert with the rule that s is /z/ intervocalically and finally but /s/ in onset (where it derives from GA /st/, GA /s/ having debuccalized to /h/). The doubled ss is therefore the standard spelling for a voiceless geminate; the formal/pedagogical variant *śś* is also licensed. Note: this convention is dictionary-internal pending propagation to orthography.md.

4. Entries

beussou

Etymology *pass out* — colloquial “fall asleep from fatigue” primary; “lose consciousness” secondary (salience inverted from GA).

Part of speech: v. IPA: /bɛːsːoː/ **Foot:** (H)(H).

Phonological development: /p^h/ → /b/ [Open: environment to be finalized — see phonology §4.1]; /æ/ → /ɛ:/; /s/ geminates to /s:/ at stressed-syllable boundary rather than debuccalizing; /aʊ/ → /o:/; coda /ʔ/ dropped (lexically conditioned in grammaticalized particles; careful-speech variant /bɛːsːoːʔ/ exists).

Definition

1. to fall asleep from fatigue; to sleep heavily.
2. to lose consciousness; to faint.

epplii

Etymology *to apply* — with ambisyllabic /p/ in GA (/əp.pɫaɪ/) phonologized as a true geminate.

Part of speech: v. IPA: /ˈɛpːli/ **Foot:** [Open].

Phonological development: initial unstressed /ə/ → /ɛ/ [Open: new rule needed — see phonology §4.2]; /p.p/ ambisyllabic → geminate /pː/; /aɪ/ → short /i/ [Open: third reflex for §4.2’s conditioning-open question].

Cross-refs: *beussou* (parallel geminate from ambisyllabic stop); *rhiiysseunnou*, *rhiiynii* (parallel *rhiiy-* prefix in alternative form *rhiiyepplii*).

Definition

1. to put, place, or spread something on something else (paint, ointment, a label).

2. to put effort into a task; to try with real effort. Sense 2 admits the alternative form *rhiiyepplii* (with the *rhiiy-* intensifier prefix, still transparent here — unlike its fully-bleached form in *rhiiysseunnou* and *rhiiynii*).
3. to apply for (a job, position, program).

hoiom

Etymology *sodium* — narrowed from the chemical element to the everyday substance.

Part of speech: n. IPA: /ˈhoiom/ **Foot:** [Open: final syllable resolution — see phonology §6.2].

Phonological development: /s/ → /h/; intervocalic /d/ elided (E1); hiatus /o.i/ retained; final /əm/ [Open: unresolved — see phonology §6.2].

Definition

1. salt (the seasoning; the mineral).

hoʔnʔnts

Etymology *countenance* — narrowed to the concrete body-part term; facial expression, demeanor, and composure senses not inherited.

Part of speech: n. IPA: /ˈhoʔnʔnts/ **Foot:** (H) with multiple syllabic-C nuclei.

Phonological development: onset /k/ → /h/; /aʊ/ → /o/; E3 schwa elision in unstressed positions; /n/ → syllabic /ŋ/; /st/ → /ts/; coda /ʔ/ preserved.

Definition

1. face (the part of the body).

Notes A showcase for syllabic-consonant phonology: three nuclei follow the stressed vowel, two of them /ŋ/ and one a complex coda /ts/. Stress remains on the initial /o/ — the syllabic consonants are moraic but not full vocalic positions for stress placement.

ritsstw

Etymology *Rochester* — toponym.

Part of speech: proper n. IPA: /ˈritsstw/ **Foot:** (H) with sesquisyllabic /w/ tail.

Phonological development: /tʃ/ → /ts/; /st/ → /ts/ (or retained as /ts/-cluster); E3 schwa elision; /ɹ/ → syllabic /w/ in final position.

Cross-refs: *toutw* (parallel sesquisyllabic /w/).

Definition

1. Rochester (the city).

Notes Used in phonology.md §6.1 as a worked example of heavy onset-and-coda clustering with a final syllabic /w/. The double /ts/ at the cluster boundary (from /tʃ/ + /st/) is phonotactically legal; cited there as a test case for sequences like tsst.

rhiiynii

Etymology *really need* — *really* bleached and lexicalized as the rhiiy- prefix; stem from *need*. The need/want polysemy collapses two GA concepts onto a single axis.

Part of speech: v. **IPA:** /ʔi:ni/ **Foot:** [Open].

Phonological development: /t/ → /j/ between high front vowels; /tʃi/ → /i:/: coda /d/ → Ø (E2, no compensatory lengthening).

Cross-refs: *rhiiysseunnou* (parallel rhiiy- prefix, fully bleached); *epplii* (intensifier variant *rhiiyepplii*, where rhiiy- is still transparent).

Definition

1. to need.
2. to want.

Notes The prefix /ʔi:-/ (rhiiy) surfaces as long /i:/ from /tʃi/-smoothing; the stem /ni/ (nii) is short /i/ from coda /d/-deletion with no compensatory lengthening. The /i:/ vs. /i/ contrast within the same word is the orthographic working rule: iiy = long /i:/ (etymologically-justified glide source), ii = short tense /i/ [Open: to be confirmed when orthography.md §3.2 is revised to admit /i:/].

rhiiysseunnou

Etymology *really stand out* — *really* bleached and lexicalized as the rhiiy- prefix; *stand out* also lexicalized as a phrasal verb in GA. Treated as a single verb in the conlang.

Part of speech: v. **IPA:** /ʔi:sɛ:nɔ:/ **Foot:** [Open].

Phonological development: /æ/-tense (pre-nasal in GA, with preserved duration) → /ɛ:/ via length reanalysis; /t/ → /j/ between high front vowels; /tʃi/ → /i:/: /st/ → /s:/ at stressed-syllable boundary; /nd/ → /n:/ in coda [Open: new rule needed — see phonology §4]; /aʊ/ → /o:/; /t/ → /ʔ/ in coda; coda /ʔ/ dropped (lexically conditioned in grammaticalized *out*).

Cross-refs: *beussou* (parallel /st/ → /s:/, parallel coda /ʔ/-drop in *out*-particle); *rhiiynii*, *epplii* (parallel rhiiy- prefix).

Definition

1. to be different; to stand apart; to be distinctive.
2. to be excellent; to excel.

Notes The rhiiy- prefix is fully bleached here and in *rhiiynii* — not felt as an intensifier, only as part of the lexicalized stem. Con-

trast *rhiiyepplii* (under *epplii* sense 2), where the same prefix is still transparent. This stratification (bleached vs. transparent) across the lexicon reflects grammaticalization at different stages.

The eu digraph unifies two diachronic sources: (1) the smoothed-schwa pathway for /ɛ:/ in orthography.md §3.2, and (2) the /æ/-with-preserved-duration pathway attested here. Both surface as eu.

ré

Etymology *today* — from colloquial GA [tʰɹɛɪ] (reduced from [tʰə'dɛɪ] via schwa elision and tap-realization). Sense 2 grammaticalizes the GA emphatic use (“done today” = “right now”) as a distinct interjectional sense.

Part of speech: (1) adv., (2) interj. **IPA:** /'ɹɛ/ **Foot:** ('L) light monosyllable.

Phonological development: /h/ + tap coalescence → /ɹ/ (M1 devoicing mechanism generalized to onset, without metathesis); two irregular shifts specific to this high-frequency colloquial form: /t/ → /h/ in onset cluster (not a regular rule); /eɪ/ → short /ɛ/ (clipping, not a regular rule).

Cross-refs: *réut* (parallel /ɹ/ onset, from M1 metathesis rather than coalescence).

Definition

1. (*adv.*) today. — *Réus bémmo ou rîbîi-hîi. Ou rîis-hîi o noê.* “It’s a little more chillier today, in a pleasant kind of way.”
2. (*interj.*) hurry!; right now!; immediately!

Notes The two irregular shifts — /t/ → /h/ and /eɪ/ → short /ɛ/ — are one-offs licensed by this form’s high frequency and rapid-speech origin, not regular rules. The convergence of irregularities in one form is the design point: high-frequency colloquial words bleed off the regular cascade, and *ré* is the canonical example.

réut

Etymology *carrot*.

Part of speech: n. **IPA:** /'ɹɛ:ʔ/ **Foot:** ('H) heavy monosyllable.

Phonological development: onset /k/ → /h/; coda /t/ → /ʔ/; M1 (rhotic metathesis: intervocalic /ɹ/ → onset, /h/ reanalyzed as devoicing feature → /ɹ/); smoothing of /æ + ə/ → /ɛ:/.

Cross-refs: *ré* (parallel /ɹ/ onset, from /h/ + tap coalescence rather than M1 metathesis).

Definition

1. carrot (the root vegetable).

Notes The canonical illustration of M1: GA onset /k/ debuccalizes to /h/, which becomes the devoicing feature on the metathesizing rhotic. Used as a worked example in phonology.md §6.1.

toutw

Etymology *to total to* — the GA tallying phrase (“the bill totals to forty dollars”) lexicalized as a single verb.

Part of speech: v. **IPA:** /tʰo:tw/ **Foot:** (‘H) with sesquisyllabic /w/ tail.

Phonological development: /ou/ → /o:/; intervocalic tap /ɾ/ elided (E1); coda /t/ → ∅ [Open: not explicitly stated in phonology §4 — see §3.2]; smoothing of /o: + ə/ → /o:/; final unstressed /u/ → syllabic /w/ (phonology §5.2 step 7).

Cross-refs: *ritsstw* (parallel sesquisyllabic /w/).

Definition

1. to cost a certain amount (of money).
2. to be present in a certain number; to amount to; to add up to.

Notes Initial /t/ is aspirated [tʰ] in stressed onset — allophonic, not marked orthographically. [Open: aspiration’s phonemic status not committed in phonology.md.]

5. Changelog

A running record of additions and changes to the dictionary, with dates and any open questions surfaced.

2026-05-17

- **Schema reformatting.** All existing entries (*beussou*, *eppli*, *hoiom*, *hoʔnʔnts*, *ritsstw*, *rhiiynii*, *rhiiysseunnou*, *ré*, *réut*, *toutw*) converted to the new prosaic format per §1: etymology line with drift folded in, single form line (POS/IPA/foot), compact Sound changes line. Explicit field headers (**GA etymology:**, **Part of speech:**, etc.) and standalone [Drift note: ...] brackets removed. Notes sections stripped of propagation tickets and paradigm-candidate flags; only form-specific observations retained.
- **Schema revision (second pass).** All 10 entries reformatted with: (1) #### Etymology as a labeled section opener; (2) explicit **Part of speech:**, **IPA:**, **Foot:** labels on the form line; (3) Sound changes renamed to Phonological development throughout. Preamble files updated to route all monospace font to Brill (\let\ttfamily\rmfamily), eliminating DejaVu Sans Mono from compiled output.

2026-04-30

- Added entry *ré* (“today”; interj. “hurry!”). High-frequency colloquial form with two irregular shifts (onset /t/ → /h/, /e/

→ short /ɛ/), neither proposed as a rule.

- **Open phonology nuance:** the /h/ + tap → /ɾ/ coalescence in onset (without M1 metathesis) is plausibly a generalization of the M1 mechanism in phonology.md §4.3 — worth clarifying when phonology is next revised.
- **Open phonology revision:** phonology.md §8.1 stipulates that degenerate (single-syllable) feet are licensed only if the syllable is heavy; *ré*’s light-monosyllabic foot /ɾɛ/ is a counterexample. The minimality clause appears to be an overgeneralization on limited data and should be relaxed when phonology is next revised.
- Added entry *beussou* (“to sleep; to pass out”).
- **Schema revision:** renamed “GA etymon” to “GA etymology” in §1, expanding the field to accommodate drift notes and source-construction context. Existing entries (*hoiom*, *hoʔnʔnts*, *réut*, *ritsstw*) updated to use the new bullet label.
- **Orthographic addition:** added §3 note on ss /s:/ as standard geminate spelling, with *śś* as formal variant. Convention is dictionary-internal pending propagation to orthography.md.
- **Open phonological question:** new rule needed in phonology.md §4.1 for /s/ → /s:/ at syllable boundary preceding stress (vs. default /s/ → /h/).
- **Open phonological question:** environment for /p/ → /b/ in onset to be finalized — current proposal is “before /ɛ/ (and long counterpart), blocked before /i, ɪ, a, o/ and clusters.”
- **Open phonological question:** §4.1’s “coda /ʔ/ never elides” needs softening to permit lexical exceptions in grammaticalized particles (e.g., *GA out* in phrasal-verb lexicalizations).
- **Open orthographic question:** with *s* predictably voiceless in onset (since onset *s* derives only from GA /st/, GA /s/ having debuccalized to /h/), the *ś* grapheme may be redundant in onset position. Worth verifying against orthography.md whether *ś* is doing real work outside non-onset environments.
- **Cross-system note:** *beussou* flagged as candidate verb for volition-paradigm illustration (language_reference.md §3.4.2).

2026-05-03

Batch addition of four verbs: *eppli*, *rhiiynii*, *rhiiysseunnou*, *toutw*. Plus collation fix for *ritsstw*.

Entries added:

- Added entry *eppli* (“to spread on; to apply oneself; to apply for”). Three senses inherited from GA *apply*’s polysemy. Sense 2 admits an alternative form *rhiiyeppli* with an *rhiiy-* intensifier prefix.
- Added entry *rhiiynii* (“to need; to want”). Lexicalizes GA *really need* with a fully-bleached *rhiiy-* prefix from *really*. The need/want polysemy is a productive cultural/grammatical

marker.

- Added entry *rhiiysseunnou* (“to be different; to be excellent”). Lexicalizes GA *really stand out* with the same fully-bleached *rhiiy-* prefix.
- Added entry *toutw* (“to cost; to amount to”). Lexicalizes GA *to total to* as a single verb.

Collation fix:

- Moved *ritsstw* to its correct position per the alphabet ($r < \acute{r}$). It had been incorrectly placed at the end of the entries section (after the $\acute{r}$ -region); it now sits between the h -region (after *hoʔnʔnts*) and the rh -region (before *rhiiynii*). No content changes to the entry itself.

Open phonological questions surfaced:

- **/i:/ as a phoneme.** orthography.md §3.2 states /i:/ does not occur in the conlang, but *rhiiysseunnou*, *rhiiynii*, and the existing *Emily* derivation in phonology.md §6.1 all attest /i:/ from /ɿji/-smoothing. §3.2 needs revision to admit /i:/ as a phoneme. The orthographic spelling *i*y is the working convention for long /i:/, with bare *ii* reserved for short tense /i/ — this contrast is on display within *rhiiynii* itself (prefix *rhiiy* /ɿi:/ vs. stem *nii* /ni/).
- **/nd/ → /n:/ in coda.** Attested in *rhiiysseunnou*. New rule needed in phonology.md §4: nasal+stop coda cluster simplifies to geminate nasal, by regressive assimilation or compensatory lengthening.
- **Coda /l/ → ∅ outside clusters.** Attested in *toutw*. phonology.md §3.2 implies this diachronic loss (since /l/ “occurs only in clusters”) but §4 does not state it explicitly. Should be added or subsumed under E2.
- **Initial unstressed /ə/ → /ɛ/.** Attested in *epplii*. New rule needed in phonology.md §4.2: initial schwa (when not absorbed or elided) strengthens to /ɛ/, paralleling the final-schwa-strengthening pathway already in §4.2.
- **/ar/ → short /i/.** Attested in *epplii*. phonology.md §4.2 lists /ai/ → /i:/ ~ /e:/ as conditioning-open; *epplii* adds short /i/ as a third reflex. Conditioning still open — possibly stressed-position-before-geminate, possibly lexically conditioned for high-frequency verbs.
- **Aspiration's phonemic status.** Surfaced by *toutw*'s /'to:tw/. Treated as allophonic and orthographically silent (English-style: voiceless stops aspirate in stressed onsets), but not yet committed in phonology.md.

Reused phonological flags from prior changelog entries (no new commitment needed, but worth noting which entries newly attest each rule):

- /st/ → /s:/ at stressed-syllable boundary — first flagged with *beussou*; now also attested in *rhiiysseunnou*.
- Coda /ʔ/ drop in lexicalized *out* — first flagged with *beussou*; now also attested in *rhiiysseunnou*.
- /t/ → /j/ between high front vowels — implicit in the *Emily*

derivation in phonology.md §6.1; now explicitly attested in *rhiiynii* and *rhiiysseunnou* as a regular rule.

Open orthographic questions surfaced:

- **Geminate-doubling generalization.** Dictionary §3 currently licenses *ss* for /s:/ only. This batch generalizes the principle: *nn* for /n:/ (in *rhiiysseunnou*), *pp* for /p:/ (in *epplii*). The unified rule — “doubled consonants represent geminates” — should be propagated to orthography.md §2.
- **eu digraph unification across two diachronic sources.** orthography.md §3.2 lists *eu* as the smoothed-schwa pathway for long /ɛ:/ only. *rhiiysseunnou* attests a second pathway: /æ/-with-preserved-duration before nasals, where GA's tense-lax distinction is reanalyzed as length. The orthography unifies both sources under *eu*. Worth recording in orthography.md as a single graphemic rule with two etymological feeds.
- **Spelling convention for /i:/ vs. short tense /i/.** Working rule (from this batch): long /i:/ is *i*y where there's an etymologically-justified glide source, and bare *ii* is short tense /i/. The contrast is on display in *rhiiynii*. To be confirmed when orthography.md §3.2 is revised.

Cross-system notes:

- *rhiiysseunnou*, *rhiiynii*, and *epplii* (sense 2) all flagged as volition-paradigm candidates (language_reference.md §3.4.2), joining *beussou*. The growing set of volition-relevant verbs is starting to anchor the eventual paradigm illustration.
- The *rhiiy-* prefix from bleached *really* shows productive stratification across the lexicon: fully bleached/lexicalized in *rhiiysseunnou* and *rhiiynii*, still functionally an intensifier in *rhiiyepplii*. This is a good candidate for a future grammatical note in language_reference.md on incomplete grammaticalization as a productive design feature.